

auk: Installing AWK for Windows

A step-by-step guide using **Cygwin**

guide v.2026



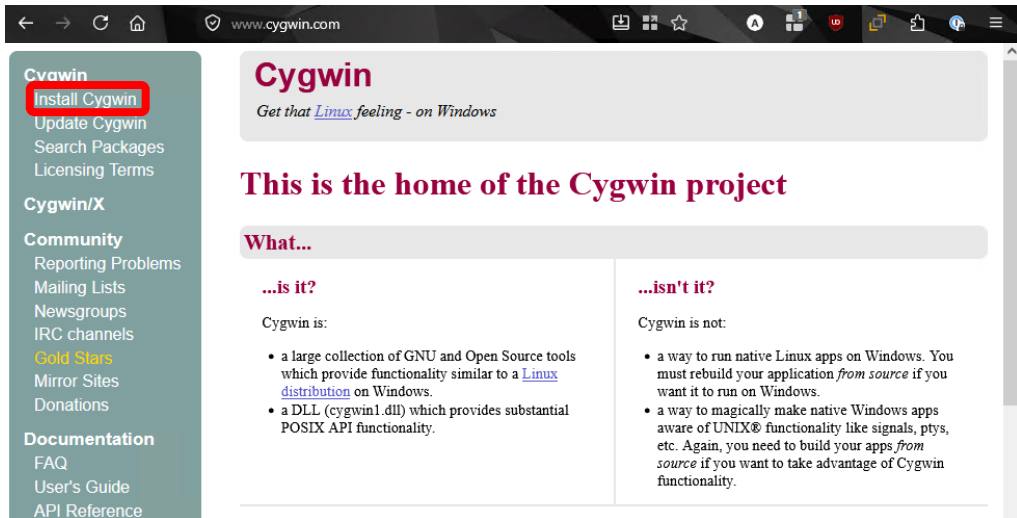
General information

- What is **auk**?
 - An R package providing a front end for **AWK**, a Unix utility and programming language for processing column formatted text data
 - The **auk** package allows users to filter eBird data before importing into R, using **AWK**
 - Learn more here:
<https://cornelllabofornithology.github.io/auk/index.html>
- Windows users must install **Cygwin** to gain access to **AWK**
 - Mac and Linux machines come with **AWK** pre-installed
- What is **Cygwin**?
 - A collection of tools that provide Linux functionality to Windows
 - Download at: <https://www.cygwin.com/>

Step 1: Access Cygwin

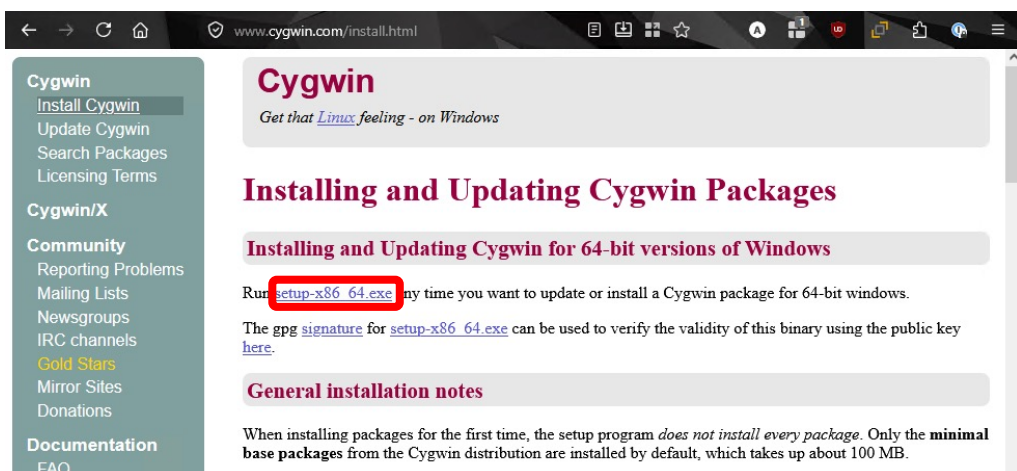
Navigate to <https://www.cygwin.com/>

Click “Install Cygwin” tab on left



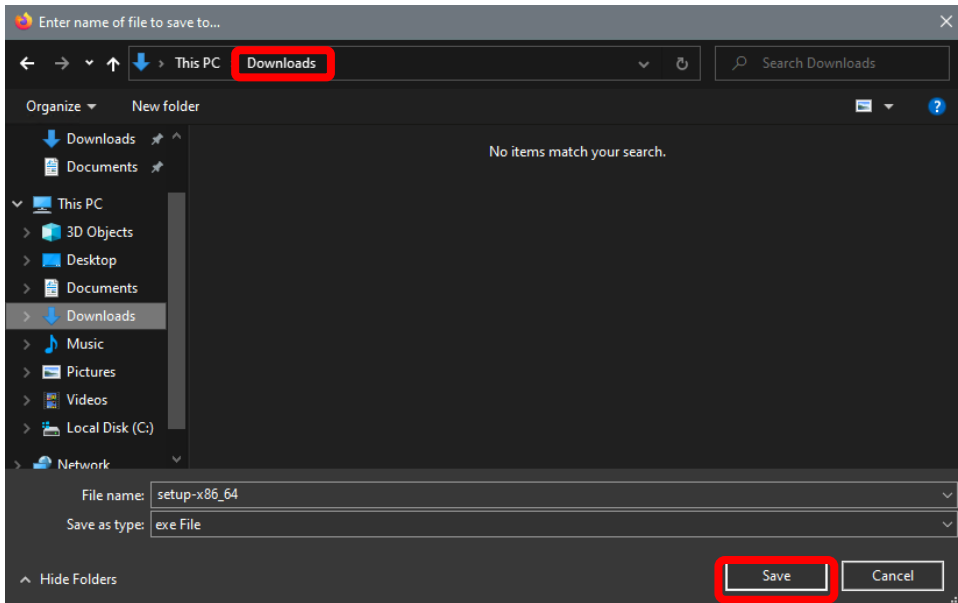
Step 2: Initiate download

Click [setup-x86_64.exe](#) link



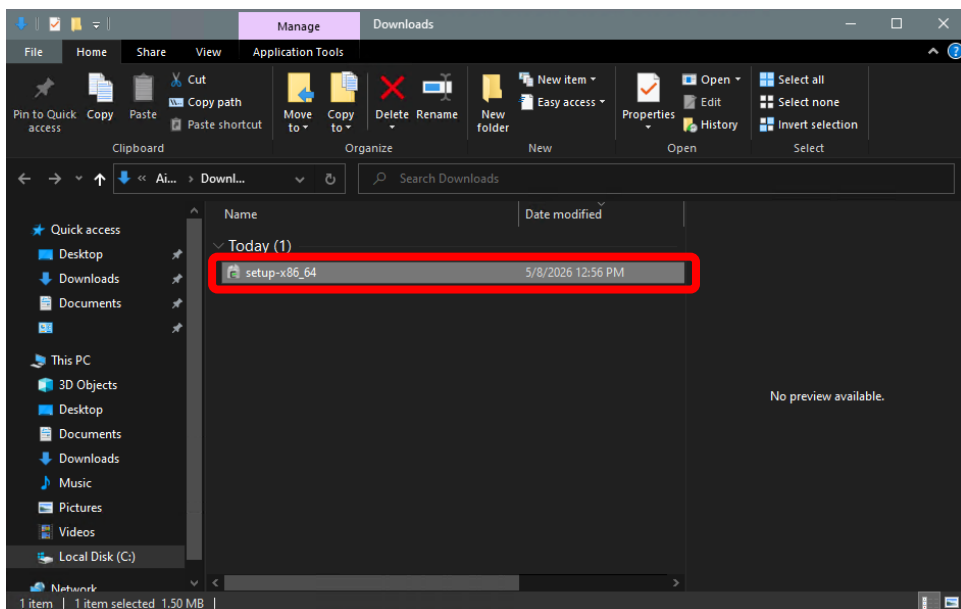
Step 3: Save installation file

Save to location of choice. Here, I've saved to my Downloads folder



Step 4: Initialize install

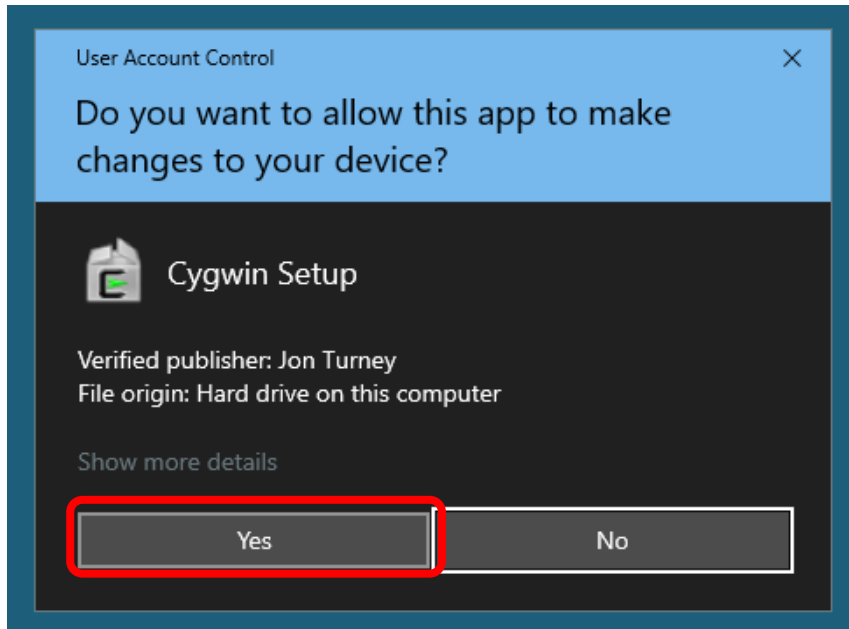
Navigate to saved location and double-click file



Step 5: Allow changes

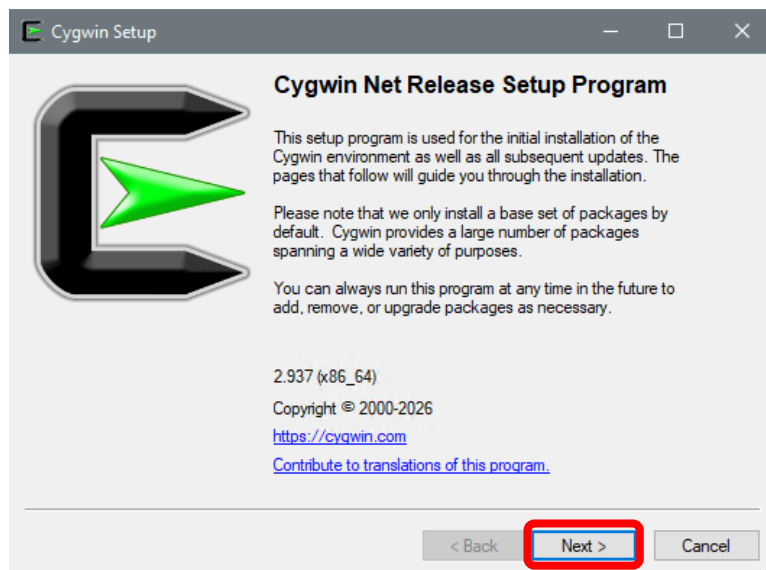
Click “Yes”

Note: May need Admin privileges on some machines



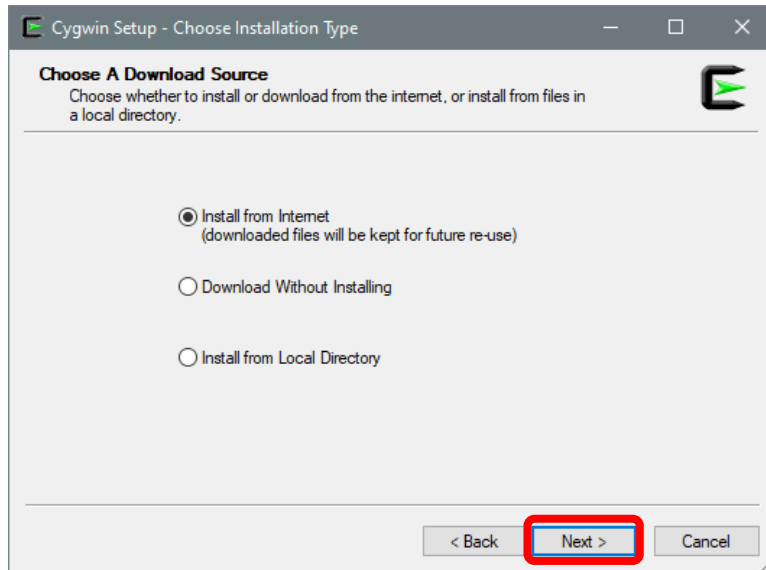
Step 6: Installation wizard pane #1

Click “Next”



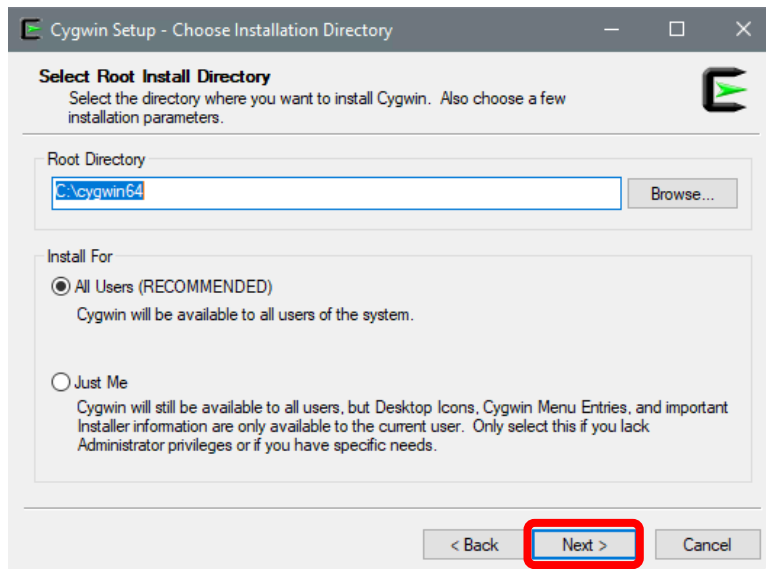
Step 7: Installation wizard pane #2

Select “Install from Internet” & click “Next”



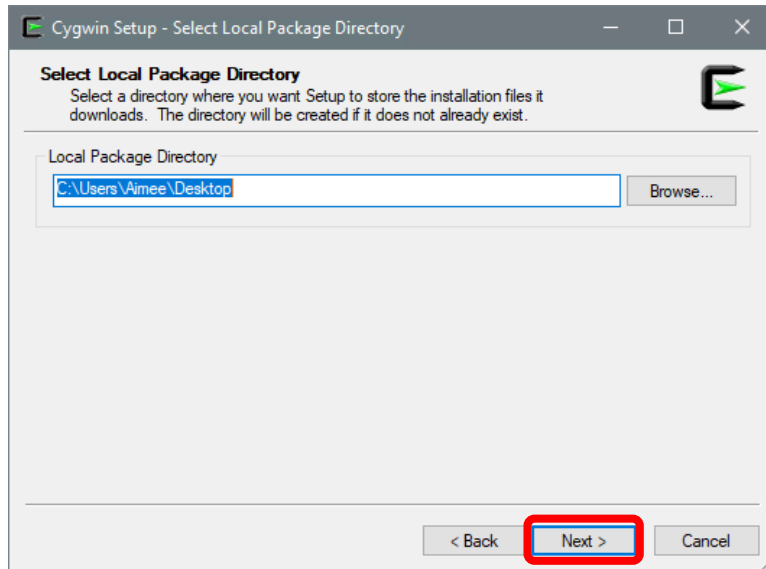
Step 8: Installation wizard pane #3

Use default install directory & install for “All Users”
Click “Next”



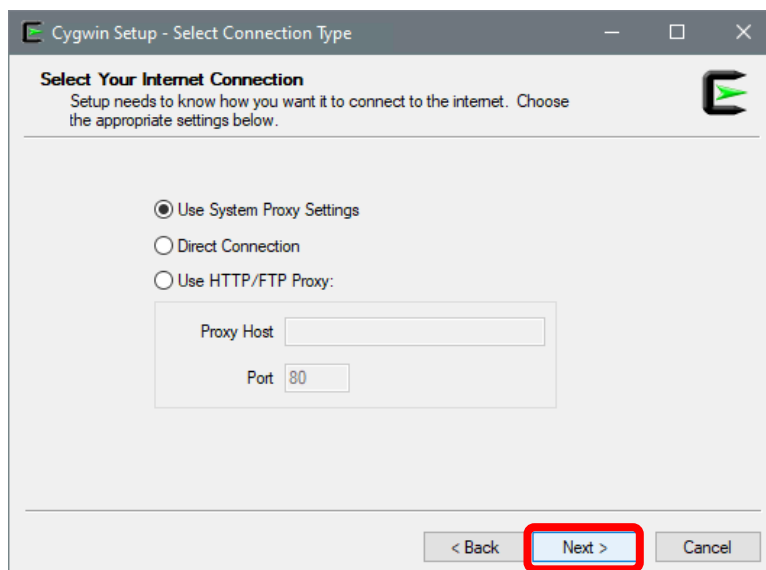
Step 9: Installation wizard pane #4

Choose location for install files—Desktop is fine
Click “Next”



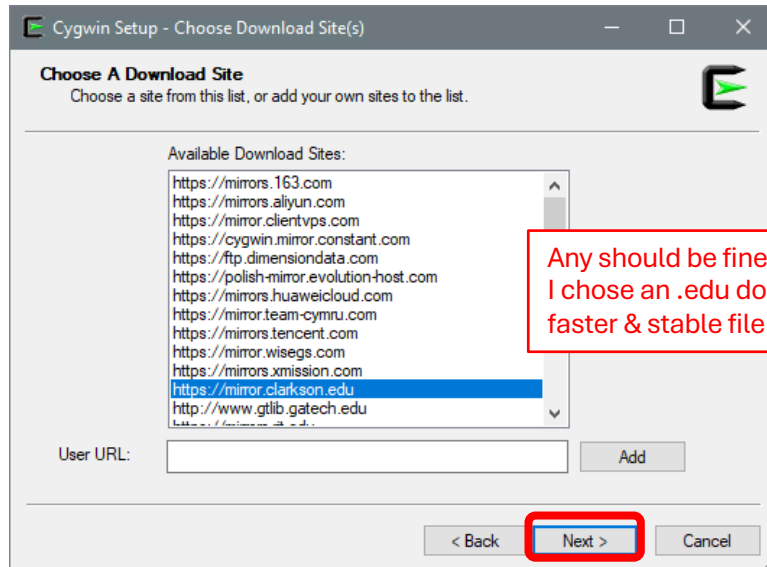
Step 10: Installation wizard pane #5

Select “Use System Proxy Settings” & click “Next”



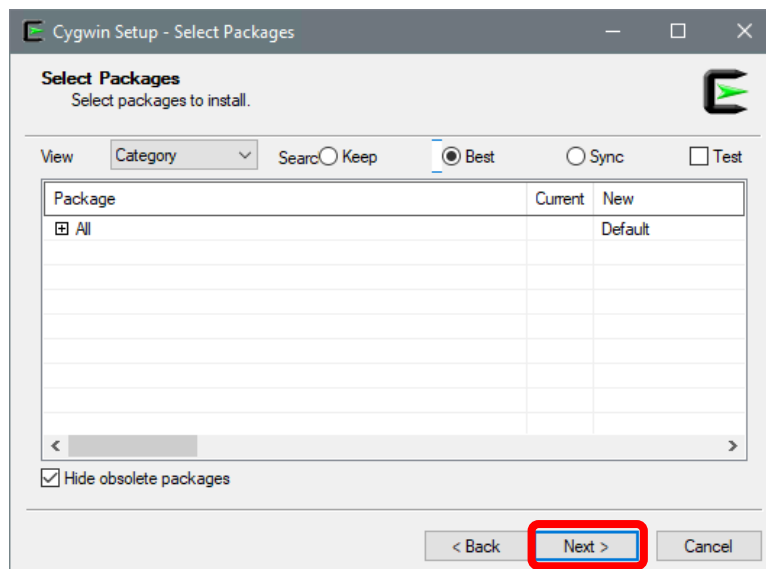
Step 11: Installation wizard pane #6

Choose site to download files from & click “Next”



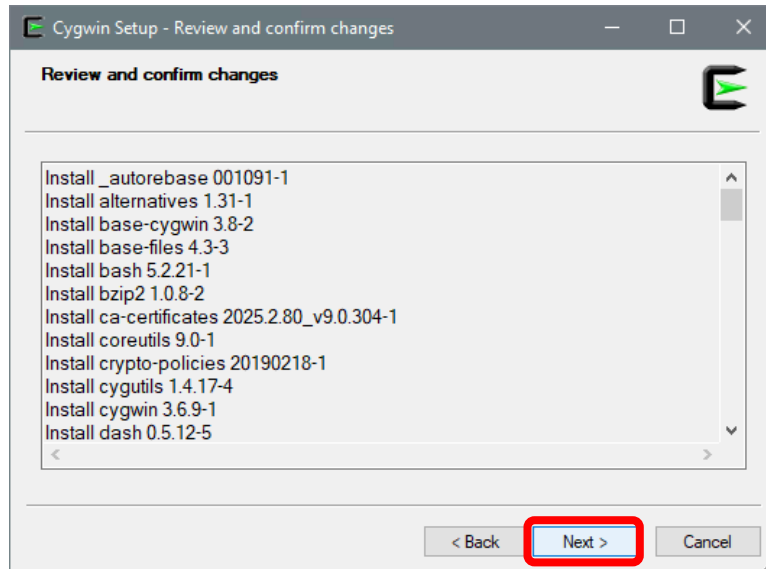
Step 12: Installation wizard pane #7

Use default—this will download only base packages
Click “Next”



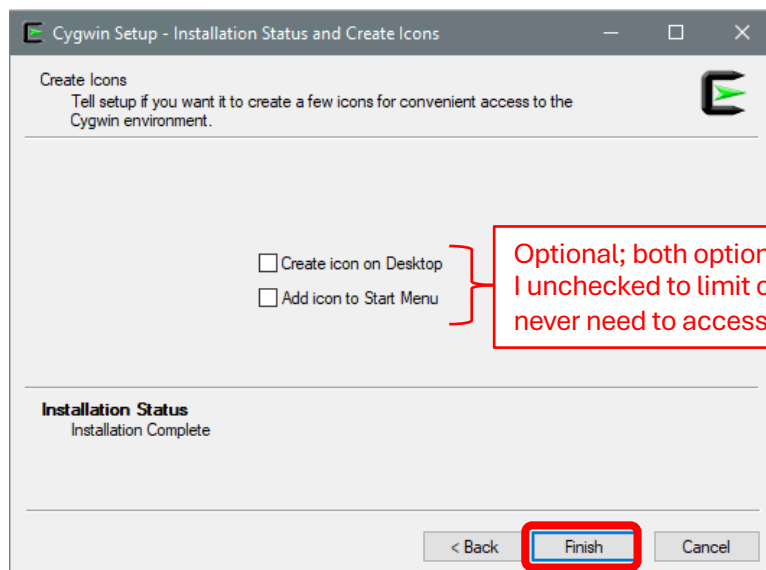
Step 13: Installation wizard pane #8

Shown are the base packages. Click “Next”



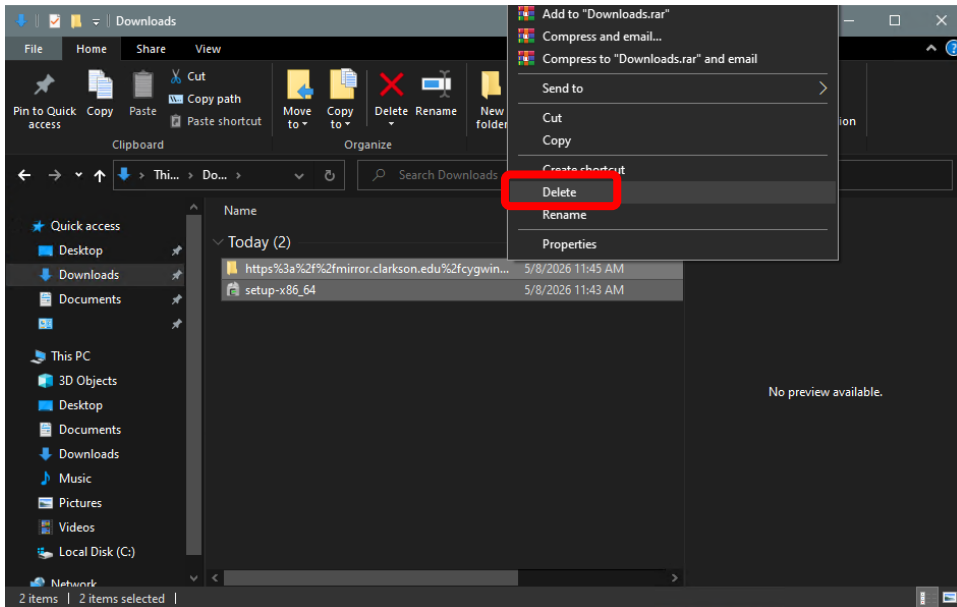
Step 14: Installation wizard pane #9

Click “Finish”



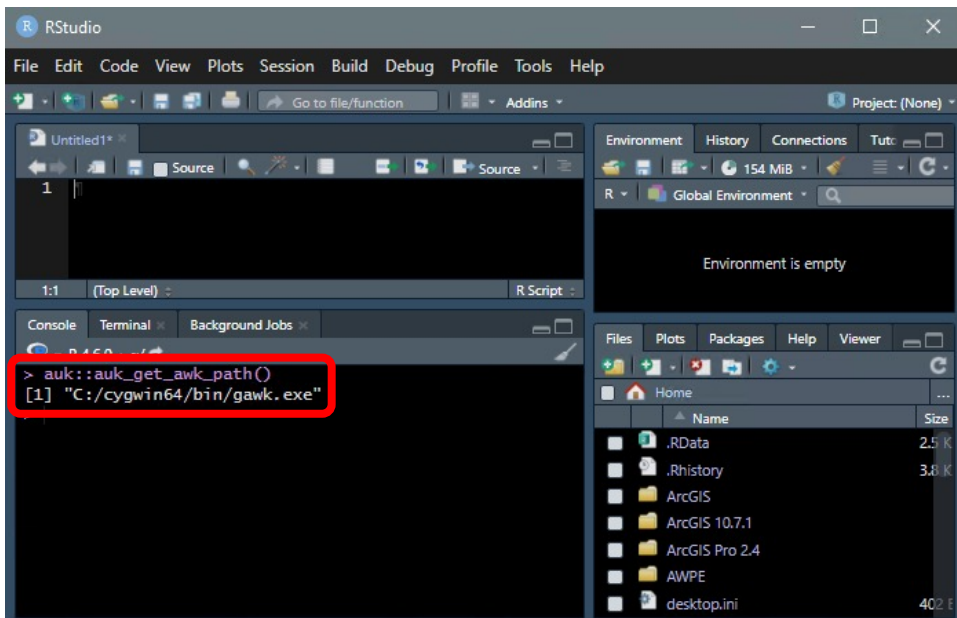
Step 15: Clean up installation files

No longer needed; send to trash



Step 16: Test **AWK** installation using R

Run “`awk::awk_get_awk_path()`”. If R returns a file path, **AWK** has been properly installed



Still having trouble?

- More information and basic troubleshooting:
<https://cornelllabofornithology.github.io/auk/articles/auk.html#awk>
- Note: **Cygwin** must be installed in the default location for **auk** to work
 - Typical defaults are “C:/cygwin/bin/gawk.exe” or “C:/cygwin64/bin/gawk.exe”
 - To check that **AWK** is installed and can be located by the **auk** package, run “`auk_get_awk_path()`”.
 - This is listed incorrectly in current **auk** documentation as “`auk_getpath()`”.